

EMERGENCIES NEED A FUND

Keeping money ready for an emergency is important. Not only do you not have to worry about the money when you need it but it also frees up money for long-term investments.

My daughter was just five when she understood the importance of a car seat belt. I would drive her to and back from a nearby school and insist that she belt up in the front seat or the back seat, wherever she chose to sit. Five is the age when ‘why’ and ‘won’t’ are at the top of the vocabulary charts. A growing sense of self allows the knee-high two-pound tigers to assert their independence. But, this was an argument I won, since it was non-negotiable. It is not often that I use the ‘I’m-bigger-and-smarter-and-you’re-just-a-little-kid’ line of parental control, but this was one of those times.

Anyhow. So, kid gives in with bad grace and sulks for a couple of days. Then gets used to it. One afternoon we’re returning home, the usual idiot in a BMW brakes too hard in front of our car – he probably thinks he’s in a commercial, showing off the dead-stop prowess of his roadrunner. I slam my brakes and we both fly forward, get restrained by the belt and miss having our heads crash through the front windshield. I exhale, call the guy some really bad names – mentally, of course, kid mustn’t know mumma knows these words – and then swing back into the traffic.